

Board meeting

November 2025

Meeting information

Date: 25 November 2025
Time: 4:00 - 5:30 PM in London / 11:00 AM - 12:30 PM in New York
Location: Please join via Zoom link in the calendar invitation
Meeting type: Regular
Notice given: March 27, 2025
Next meeting: TBA

Executive summary

The Board convened to formalize new appointments, approve prior minutes, and receive comprehensive updates from the executive team. Key discussions focused on organizational growth, curation efficiency, and technical advancements, including the integration of automation and improved funder reporting. The organization is showing strong development in its curation processes and technical infrastructure. Key outcomes included the formalization of the 2024-2025 board leadership and the approval of the organization's recent strategic reports.

Formalities

Attendance

The following directors, constituting a quorum of the Board of Directors (the "Board") of DRYAD, were present at the meeting:

1. Andrea Chiarelli
2. Antrew Beckerman
3. Scott Edmunds
4. Brooks Hanson
5. Devika Madalli
6. Jason William
7. Bekah Darksmith
8. Jake Carlson
9. Mona Ramonetti (leaving early)
10. Jennifer Gibson (ex-officio)

The following directors were absent:

11. Barbara Ebert
12. Ian Mulvany
13. Daniel Potter
14. Juan Diego Espitia

The following guests were present:

- Maria Guerreiro
- Dan Edwards
- Ryan Scherle

Quorum (7):

Yes - eight members present

Call to order

The Chairperson of the Board, Andrew Beckerman (the "Chair") called the meeting to order at 11:00 .

Approval of meeting minutes

The October Board minutes were presented for approval.

- Motion: To approve the motion to approve the minutes of October 2025
- Result: 8 in favor - motion carried

Agenda items

1. Preliminaries

No conflicts of interest were declared by any members present.

2. New Directors and officers

The Chair officially welcomed two new members, Andrea and Juan Diego.

Officer appointments for the upcoming term were formalized:

- Chair of the Board: Andrew P. Beckerman.
- Vice Chair: Ian Mulvany.
- Secretary: Barbara Ebert (replacing outgoing secretary Mona, who was thanked for her service).
- Chair of the Finance Committee: Bekah Darksmith

3. Dryad Health Check

The Executive Director, Jen Gibson, provided an update on the organization's health, using the traffic light system:

Platform Development (Green): The team has achieved a strong and stable pace for feature development and is able to address some back log and system improvements.

Partnership Development (Yellow): Talent is high, but the team is over-capacity, handling renewals and new partners beyond their initial remit.

Data Publishing (Green/Improving): Formerly "Red," the department has moved to "Unstable but Improving" due to successful backlog management.

Finance (Steady/Diversified): Transitioning to a more complex but resilient financial picture.

4. Executive team presentations

The executive team presented a comprehensive update on the organization's trajectory, focusing on balancing rapid growth with operational efficiency.

Data Publishing:

- Volume and Throughput: There has been a notable increase in published data sets and submissions; however, this has also led to a higher volume of "Active Author Revisions" (AARs) where submissions must be returned for clarification
- Curation Quality: The curation team is focusing on "mechanical steps" of the process, identifying that a significant portion of rejections stem from incomplete README files
- NIH GREI Program: The team highlighted ongoing participation in the NIH Generalist Repository Ecosystem Initiative (GREI), which focuses on making data from NIH-funded research more discoverable and reusable.

Partnerships

- Retention and Growth: While some existing partners have chosen not to renew, the loss is being offset by a steady influx of new institutional partners.
- Legal Workload: A significant administrative challenge was noted regarding institutional agreements; many new partners require custom "redlining" of standard terms, a manual process currently managed personally by the Executive Director.

Platform

- Automation and AI: The development team is working on integrating AI tools to automate the review of README files, which is expected to significantly reduce the manual curation workload.
- Technical Enhancements: Ryan Scherle (Head of Platform Development) is leading efforts to implement API lookups for funder information, allowing the platform to automatically pull grant titles and divisions directly into the submission metadata.

Business

- Financial Overview and Resilience: The Executive Director reported that while there has been some "softness" in renewals from certain segments of the community, this is being effectively balanced by an influx of new institutional partners
- Revenue Growth: Total revenue is significantly higher than originally projected for the current stage, which the team attributes to a more "diversified revenue mix" than in previous years.
- Operational Challenges: A primary business bottleneck identified is the legal and administrative workload associated with onboarding new institutional partners. Specifically, many institutions require extensive "redlining" and customization of standard membership agreements.
- Strategic Opportunity: The board discussed leveraging Dryad's unique position as a "community-led" and "mission-driven" nonprofit to differentiate itself from commercial competitors in the data repository market.
- Funding Alignment: The business strategy remains heavily aligned with federal data-sharing mandates, specifically through the continued participation in the NIH GREI initiative, which strengthens the value proposition for institutional memberships.

6. AOB

The Chair expressed gratitude to the Dryad team for their detailed reports, noting the value of the insights provided for board oversight. Final acknowledgments were given to the staff for their work in driving organizational development.

Adjournment

Having no further business to discuss, the Chair moved to adjourn the meeting at 12:25.

Date: May 13th, 2026



Barbara Ebert, Secretary